build-up of one platoon at each of these passes!'[2] Thus India effectively pre-empted the Pakistani plans, and not only reclaimed its rightful territory but also restored the alignment of the LoC in a northward direction. Indian troops are deployed on all tactically important places on the Saltoro range. Pakistan responded by deploying its army on the lower heights and slopes on the western side, but they were not able to come close to the Siachen glacier. This is now referred to as the AGPL.

By firmly holding the Saltoro range, we physically denied them even a peep into the Siachen glacier. Pakistan has been falsely projecting to its people and to foreigners that its soldiers are fighting on the Siachen glacier. The reality is that the contest is for the control of the Saltoro range, which as of now is firmly in Indian hands.

In the 1980s and 1990s, the Pakistan Army undertook many unsuccessful ventures to try and capture some of these important passes or heights. The first such attack by the Pakistani forces, comprising Northern Light Infantry and commandos from the Special Services Group (SSG) took place on 25 April 1984 but was repulsed and they suffered many casualties. On the other hand, 8 J&K LI, in a gallant action, captured the highest Pakistani observation post called Qaid in June 1987. For this mission Subedar Bana Singh won the Param Vir Chakra. In retaliation, Pakistan launched a major attack in September 1987 called Operation Qiadat,[3] with one infantry battalion and two SSG companies with TOW missiles alongwith artillery and mortars in support. Because of the altitude and glaciated terrain, a large-sized operation is impossible. Therefore, a series of attacks were launched to capture some positions on the Bilafond La Pass from 23–25 September 1987. It is believed that Pakistani President General Zia-ul-Haq had entrusted this task to the then brigadier, Pervez Musharraf, who is said to have planned the attacks from the SSG base at Khapalu in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK). Reportedly, close to a hundred Pakistani officers and men died in this operation and more than that